



WINNING THAT GOVERNMENT CONTRACTING AWARD · SESSION 2 OF 4

Team Roles and Responsibilities

Brandon Mason · Maryland Small Business Development Center
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Scan now: your worksheet

BEFORE WE START

Scan your worksheet

- 1** **Point your phone camera at the code.** Or click the link in the Zoom chat.
- 2** **Fill in page 1 now.** Name, email, business, where you are today.
- 3** **Keep the tab open.** We come back to it three times today.

Link is in the Zoom chat

When you submit at the end, the slides, the compliance matrix template and every link from today land in your inbox.



TODAY

What we're covering

01 The full proposal team at a glance

03 What each role does (and doesn't)

05 Scaling it for a small business

02 The six functional areas

04 Color reviews: built-in quality control

06 Where small businesses drop the ball

Six areas, eighteen hats

1

Business development

Business developer · lead executive

2

Capture & proposal mgmt

Capture manager · proposal manager · coordinator · volume leads

3

Proposal development

Writer · editor · graphic artist · desktop publishing

4

Solution development

Solution architect · program manager

5

Contracts & pricing

Contracts manager · subcontracts manager · cost strategist

6

Color review teams

Review team lead · reviewers

AREA 1

Business development



Find it, qualify it

Business developer	finds opportunities, builds relationships, qualifies leads
Lead executive	opens doors, sets strategic direction

In a small business, both are usually you. That continuity is an advantage.

- Monitor SAM.gov, GovWin, agency forecasts
- Build relationships with COs and program managers
- Attend industry days and pre-solicitation conferences
- Qualify opportunities through the pipeline
- Make the first Go/No-Go recommendation

AREA 2

Capture & proposal management



Capture manager: owns the win

- Writes the capture strategy and win themes
- Manages customer engagement through the pursuit
- Coordinates the competitive analysis
- Drives Go/No-Go with data
- Hands the knowledge to the proposal team when the RFP drops

Write it down.

Usually the owner. Make it intentional.

Proposal manager: owns the process

- Builds the proposal schedule; tracks deadlines
- Builds the compliance matrix (Section L → Section M)
- Assigns sections to writers and volume leads
- Runs the daily stand-ups
- Runs the color reviews
- Owns final production and submission

PRIMARY TOOL

Compliance matrix

Maps every requirement in Section L to every evaluation criterion in Section M. Template in your inbox today; we use it in Session 3.

Two hats, one head



Same person is fine. Know which hat you're wearing.

Coordinator & volume leads

PROPOSAL COORDINATOR

- Manages the shared drive and tools
- Tracks document versions
- Printing, binding, shipping if hard copy
- Verifies clearances

VOLUME LEADS

- One lead per major volume
- Technical · Management · Past Performance · Cost
- Owns that volume's compliance and quality

AREA 3

Proposal development

The people who build the document

Writer

Drafts sections from the win themes and the compliance requirements

Editor

Consistency, grammar, readability, page limits

Graphic artist

Original process diagrams, org charts, schedules. Not clip art.

Desktop publishing

Layout, fonts, margins, headers, page numbers: final production

Proposal writing is a skill. A good writer can move you from a 70 to a 90.

WORKSHEET CHECKPOINT · SECTION A

Which hats are you wearing?

Tap Next to Section A. Tick every role you cover yourself today, then name the one you're skipping and who could cover it.

Link is in the Zoom chat



Lost the tab? Scan again.

AREA 4

Solution development

How we'll do the work

Solution architect	designs the technical approach and methodology
Program manager	plans execution, staffing and management

Often the owner. You have the substance; the hard part is making an evaluator who never met you score it high. Pair with a writer.

- Technical approach and methodology
- Work breakdown structure (WBS)
- Staffing plan and org chart
- Risks and mitigations
- Transition plan from the incumbent
- Quality control and performance measures

AREA 5

Contracts & pricing

Where proposals win or die

Contracts manager	terms, conditions, FAR / DFARS compliance
Subcontracts manager	teaming agreements, flow-downs
Cost strategist	price-to-win, builds the cost volume

Cost volume = direct labor + indirect rates + ODCs + fee. Contract type (FFP, T&M, cost-plus) changes all of it.

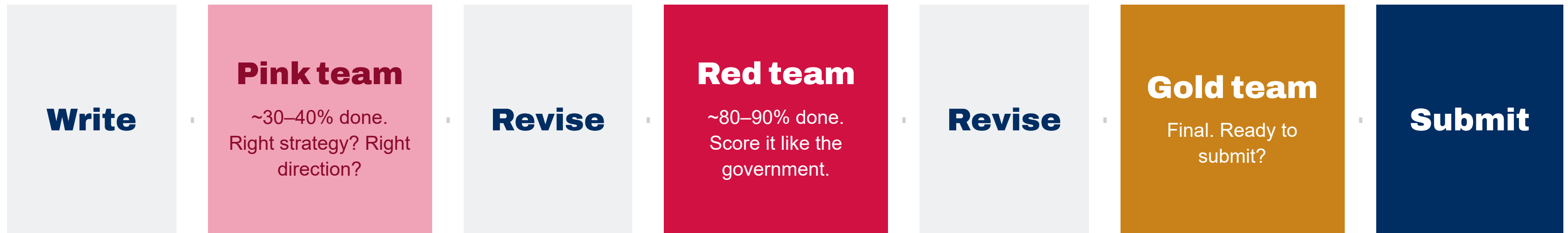
Get help here.

Government pricing is not commercial pricing.

AREA 6

Color review teams

Pink, red, gold



Small business version: 2 or 3 trusted outside readers.

Your version of the team

Who does it in a small business	
BD & capture	You, the owner
Proposal manager	You, or your most organized person
Writer	You, or a hired proposal writer
Solution architect	You, the technical expert
Pricing	You, or a govcon accountant
Color reviews	2 or 3 trusted outside reviewers

Three things worth outsourcing

1

Proposal writing

If writing isn't your strength. It moves your technical score.

2

Cost volume

If you're new to government accounting. Non-compliant pricing sinks a great proposal.

3

Color reviews

You can't objectively review your own work. Buy them dinner.

Everything else you can do yourself, on purpose.

WORKSHEET CHECKPOINT · SECTION B

Who reads it before you submit?

Section B: pick who reads your next proposal, name one person you could ask to review it, and the one function you'd get help with first.

Link is in the Zoom chat



Lost the tab? Scan again.

WATCH FOR THESE

Where small businesses drop the ball

CAN SINK YOU

- No compliance matrix: guessing at what's required
- Cost volume as an afterthought
- No version control: the final has mismatches

COSTS YOU POINTS

- No capture strategy: writing starts when the RFP drops
- Owner does everything: burns out, ships a B-
- No review cycle: nobody reads it first

TODAY

What to remember

1

Functions, not titles

Every function gets covered, whatever your size

2

Write the capture plan

The most critical and most skipped role

3

Know your hat

Strategy and execution are different mindsets

4

Buy help wisely

Writing and pricing pay for themselves

5

Review before you submit

Color reviews are free quality control

6

Build your reviewers now

Before the RFP drops, not after

Submit your worksheet

FRIDAY, OCT 2 · 10:00 A.M. · SESSION 3

How to read an RFP

- What every section of a solicitation means
- Sections L and M, side by side
- Building your compliance matrix
- What the government is really asking for

WORKSHEET · SECTION C

Write your one step, then submit.

Your inbox gets: this deck with notes, the compliance matrix template, and every link from today.





Questions?

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